

Tennessee Comprehensive Assessment Program

TCAP

Social Studies
Grade 7
Practice Items



1 | Seventh Grade Social Studies Practice Items

The excerpt describes a historical figure from the Middle Ages.

And in those days the Mongol tribes were not united and did not obey one another. . . . He became . . . like a roaring lion.

— Ata-Malik Juvaini, *The History of the World Conqueror*, c.1260

Which historic event is described in this excerpt?

- A.** the rise of Genghis Khan
- B.** the travels of Marco Polo
- C.** the conquests of Mehmed II
- D.** the journey of Mansa Musa

2 | Seventh Grade Social Studies Practice Items

Which action gave Kublai Khan greater control of China during the Yuan Dynasty?

- A.** Establishing schools to teach the Mongol language throughout China.
- B.** Eliminating all religions except Buddhism to unify the people in one belief system.
- C.** Ending the civil service exams to allow foreigners to attain government positions.
- D.** Expanding the Chinese navy to increase trade with Mongol allies.

3 | Seventh Grade Social Studies Practice Items

Which journey resulted from the reopening of the Silk Road during the Middle Ages?

- A.** Mansa Musa traveled to Egypt and Arabia.
- B.** Marco Polo traveled to the courts of China.
- C.** Christopher Columbus attempted to sail toward Japan.
- D.** Vasco da Gama sailed around the southern tip of Africa.

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The passage below describes an event during the Ming dynasty in China.

In the early 1400s, the Ming dynasty sponsored a series of sea voyages to demonstrate its naval supremacy and to search for new markets. Led by Admiral Zheng He, the voyages covered a large part of the Indian Ocean and its surrounding lands. The farthest of the voyages included stops in eastern Africa. A fleet of about 200 vessels was built for the largest expedition. The ships carried silk, porcelain, and lacquerware. They came back to China with spices, ivory, exotic woods, and pearls acquired from the many port cities they visited.

These voyages illustrate an effect of which aspect of early Ming rule?

- A.** influence of isolationism on political decisions
- B.** influence of religion on economic activity
- C.** desire to improve border defenses
- D.** desire to display imperial power

5 | Seventh Grade Social Studies Practice Items

Which feature of Japanese culture was **most** directly influenced by Chinese culture?

- A. militarism
- B. feudalism
- C. spirit worship
- D. written language

6 | Seventh Grade Social Studies Practice Items

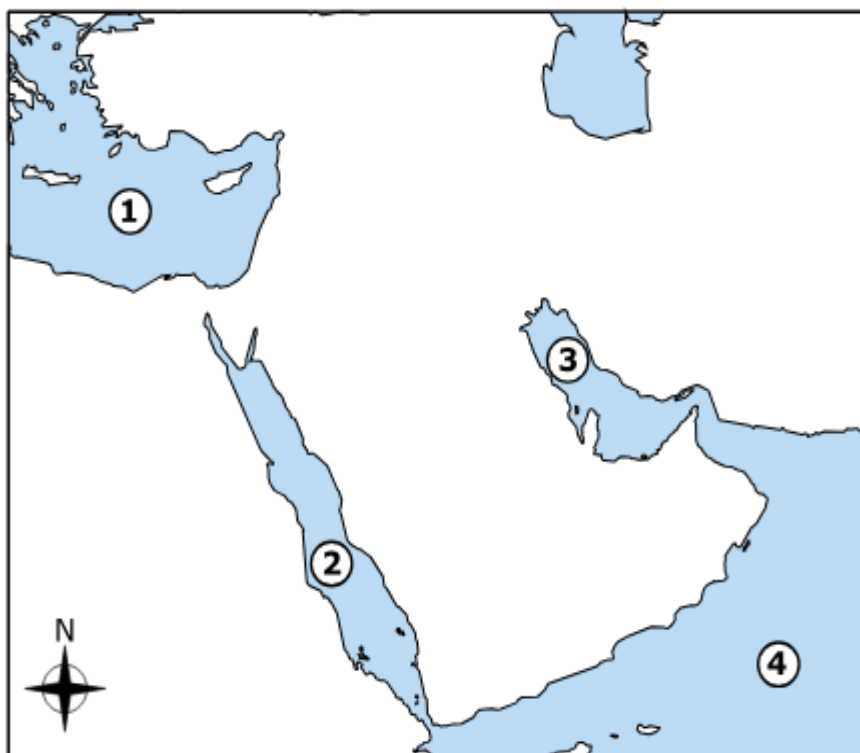
Which role did a shogun have in Japanese society?

- A.** royal assistant
- B.** religious scholar
- C.** military governor
- D.** commercial trader

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The map features the geography of Southwest Asia.

Southwest Asia



Which number correctly identifies a body of water bordering the Arabian Peninsula?

- A.** 1 — Atlantic Ocean
- B.** 2 — Red Sea
- C.** 3 — Indian Ocean
- D.** 4 — Caspian Sea

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The belief system associated with the Sunnah also includes

- A.** African origins and griots.
- B.** Aryan origins and the Vedas.
- C.** Mohammad and the Five Pillars.
- D.** Confucius and *The Analects*.

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Which statement describes the primary method for the early spread of the Arabic language?

- A.** Merchants traded between Southwest Asia and North Africa.
- B.** Monks sought to translate ancient Shinto texts.
- C.** Missionaries journeyed along the Silk Road into Europe.
- D.** Monarchs sent explorers to locate a new route to India.

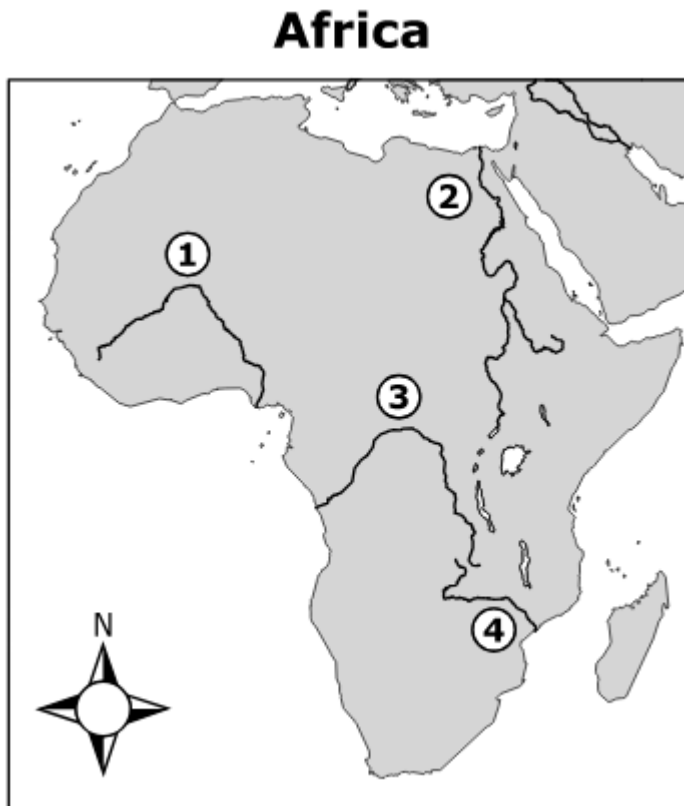
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Which **two** changes were a direct result of the rule of Mehmed II the Conqueror?

- A.** The Byzantine Empire ended.
- B.** An Ottoman parliament was created.
- C.** Constantinople was renamed Istanbul.
- D.** The city walls of Jerusalem were rebuilt.
- E.** Northern Africa was conquered by the Ottomans.

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The map displays the geography of Africa.



Which river is closest to the city of Djenne?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 4

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The information below relates to the historical development of West Africa.

One of the main aspects of the development of West African kingdoms was the emergence of cities. The first city, Koumbi Saleh, grew on the edge of the Sahara where the Kingdom of Ghana developed around it. Further inland, three bustling centers emerged along the Niger River: Djenné, Timbuktu, and Gao. These cities were the major sites of trading activity in the Malian Empire. Gao eventually broke from a declining Mali and created the Songhai Empire.

Which conclusion is supported by the information and your knowledge of West Africa?

- A.** Outside influences caused cities to decline.
- B.** Exhaustion of resources forced cities to change.
- C.** Trading centers promoted regional development.
- D.** Conflicts among cities hindered cultural advancement.

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The trade of which product was important to the growth of Ghana and Mali?

- A.** gold
- B.** paper
- C.** silk
- D.** spices

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Which statement **best** explains the purpose of the griots in ancient West African civilizations?

- A.** Griots were elected to be the leaders of rural villages.
- B.** Griots served as translators for foreign merchants.
- C.** Griots were relied on to preserve oral histories.
- D.** Griots served as religious teachers for small communities.

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The list describes historical events related to the Mali Empire.

Mali Empire, 14th Century

- The Mali Empire experienced rapid economic growth.
- Mansa Musa traveled across Africa into the Arabian Peninsula.
- Mansa Musa spent vast amounts of gold during his travels.

Which statement explains the importance of the events in the list?

- A.** Economic inflation caused the Ghana Empire to collapse.
- B.** Mali established trade networks along the Indian subcontinent.
- C.** Economic depression caused the Byzantine Empire to experience civil unrest.
- D.** Mali became legendary for the wealth of its rulers.

Which statement describes a long-term impact of the Battle of Hastings in 1066?

- A.** It ended the era of significant French influence in English politics.
- B.** It led to an agreement protecting certain rights of English subjects.
- C.** It led to the introduction of new cultural elements into English society.
- D.** It started an era when Spain became a model for the English monarchy.

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Which issue was a **major** source of conflict between European monarchs and the Papacy during the Middle Ages?

- A. access to trade routes
- B. control of universities
- C. managing government records
- D. appointment of church officials

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The chart shows the causes and effects of an event.

?	
Causes	Effects
• Defend the Holy Lands • Help for Byzantine rulers	• Knowledge of other cultures • Demand for Asian luxury goods

Which title completes the chart?

- A.** Christian Monasteries
- B.** Renaissance Culture
- C.** The Reformation
- D.** The Crusades

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The paragraph below discusses a change in European society during the Middle Ages.

During the Late Middle Ages, towns developed near manors as places to exchange goods. The towns were largely under the control of the feudal lords who lived in the manors. At the time, the king had very little authority over the feudal lords because they were in charge of the knights who defended the kingdom, and they controlled much of the wealth in the form of land. However, the weakness of the king in comparison to the lords benefited the people living in towns. The king discovered he could gain the loyalty of the townspeople if he granted them certain privileges. For example, kings sometimes allowed townspeople to pay lower taxes and to participate in their town's government. Because of this, the residents of the towns sometimes had more freedom than people living in rural areas.

How did the change described in the paragraph affect the economy of Europe?

- A.** Manors became less important in producing wealth.
- B.** Towns became less important as centers of commerce.
- C.** Towns began creating armies to take land for growing crops.
- D.** Manors began importing goods directly from foreign merchants.

Which source would **most likely** provide information about the actions of Joan of Arc?

- A. a book about the Norman invasion
- B. a poem about the Hundred Years' War
- C. a painting created during the Renaissance era
- D. a building constructed during the Enlightenment era

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What were **two** effects of Ferdinand and Isabella's reign of Spain?

- A.** the reopening of the Silk Road
- B.** the completion of the Reconquista
- C.** the start of the last Crusade
- D.** the creation of the Inquisition
- E.** the outbreak of the bubonic plague

Which statement describes Thomas Aquinas's contribution to Christianity during the Middle Ages?

- A.** He argued that members should have a say in the decisions of their local church.
- B.** He argued that religious faith and philosophical reason were in agreement with each other.
- C.** He criticized the principle that popes and monarchs had an important role in governing society.
- D.** He opposed laws that made it a crime to question scientific theories approved by the church.

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How did the technology developed by Johann Gutenberg **most** influence Europe during the Renaissance?

- A.** Armies developed more complex strategies.
- B.** Harvesting crops became more efficient.
- C.** New information spread more quickly.
- D.** Exploration of new trade routes became possible.

The map features the location of some American Indian cultures.

Some Southeast American Indian Cultures



How did geographic features affect the groups shown on this source?

- A.** These cultures relied heavily on fertile soil for the production of corn.
- B.** Mountainous terrain led to a profitable trade in lumber.
- C.** These cultures relied heavily on open plains for hunting buffalo.
- D.** River valleys allowed these groups to move frequently.

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The sources describe goods exchanged in American Indian communities.

Traces of a chemical found in cacao — the main ingredient in chocolate — were found in several drinking vessels from various sites in . . . Chaco Canyon, New Mexico. . . . The findings suggest the New Mexico complex also served as a trading hub for Mesoamericans and Puebloans.

— National Geographic

Scholars have long known that a drink made from cacao was consumed in ancient Mesoamerica. Some Maya cylinder jars even incorporate [include] paintings of the precious liquid being poured for rulers and gods, though average people sometimes consumed it as well. The Maya ground the beans; mixed them with spices, chilies, and water; and frothed [made foamy] the drink for consumption either hot or cold.

Most of the jars found in the famous cache [storage area] at Pueblo Bonito [in Chaco Canyon, New Mexico] are more than twice as tall as they are wide and painted with black designs on a white background. Because of their distinct shape and exclusive locations, archaeologists have typically agreed that they were used ritually. Ideas about their use include that they were storage for turquoise or prayer sticks, or that animal skins were stretched over them to create drums. . . .

Cylinder jars exhibited . . . a conclusive [definite] indicator of cacao or chocolate. The implications [consequences] of this find are extraordinary. The cacao plant grows only in certain tropical climates, and the nearest possibility for Chaco is Central Mexico. We already know the Chacoan people traded with Mesoamerican cultures for exotics like copper bells and Scarlet Macaws, but cacao suggests a more ritual connection than other Mesoamerican goods. In some Maya ceremonies a cacao beverage was frothed by pouring the liquid from one vessel to another. Likewise, the cacao found at Chaco was probably in liquid form because the residue [remnants] had absorbed into the clay itself. Further, the limited distribution of the cylinder jars could be evidence that only an elite or small segment of the population consumed the beverage.

— National Park Service

Based on this information, which statement **best** describes trade between indigenous cultures in the Americas?

- A. Military conquest resulted in the long-distance exchange of goods.
- B. Neighboring tribes were allowed to participate in local trade networks.
- C. Long-distance exchange of goods suggests that cultural traditions were shared.
- D. Missionaries were sent to teach religious customs to the members of other tribes.

How did the geographical features of South America affect the Incan civilization?

- A.** Large freshwater lakes allowed the creation of floating gardens.
- B.** Nearby rivers permitted the development of agricultural irrigation systems.
- C.** Slash-and-burn agriculture was needed due to thick forests.
- D.** Terrace farming was developed due to the mountainous terrain.

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The chart lists information about two civilizations.

1	2
Built cities in jungles	Built cities on mountains
Created a complex calendar	Created a road system
Rule by kings in city-states	Rule by an emperor

Which civilizations **best** complete the source?

- A.** 1 — Aztec; 2 — Maya
- B.** 1 — Incan; 2 — Aztec
- C.** 1 — Maya; 2 — Aztec
- D.** 1 — Maya; 2 — Incan

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Which statement **best** describes a result of Jacques Cartier's voyages?

- A.** France created trading settlements in North America.
- B.** A route around the tip of Africa was discovered.
- C.** Spain established an overseas empire in South America.
- D.** An all-water route to Asia was discovered.

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The image displays a significant innovation.

Astrolabe



© iStock.com/Jodie Coston #5968490

Which statement identifies how this instrument helped in the voyages to the Americas during the era of exploration?

- A.** It was used to determine latitude.
- B.** It determined the rise of the tide.
- C.** It was used to locate ocean currents.
- D.** It calculated wind speed.

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How did the religious divisions among European countries influence religion in the New World?

- A.** England established Protestant settlements in South America.
- B.** Dutch and Spanish settlements were Catholic.
- C.** English and Portuguese settlements were Protestant.
- D.** France established Catholic settlements in North America.

Metadata- Social Studies Items

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7	MC	B	7.15
8	MC	C	7.16
9	MC	A	7.17
10	MS	A, C	7.19
11	MC	A	7.21
12	MC	C	7.23
13	MC	A	7.24
14	MC	C	7.25
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28	MC	A	7.59
29	MC	A	7.60
30	MC	D	7.61
Metadata Definitions			
Item Type	Indicates the type of item. MC= Multiple Choice; MS= Multiple Select		
Key	Correct answer.		
TN Standards	Primary educational standard assessed.		